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United States Patent	12406326
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
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Circuit apparatus, display system, and image processing method

Abstract

A circuit apparatus includes a memory unit and a warp processing unit. The memory unit stores a warp object image. The warp processing unit performs warp processing on the warp object image and generates a display image displayed in a display area. The warp processing unit performs the warp processing on an image of a first view object of the warp object image based on a first warp parameter for vibration correction and distortion correction. Further, the warp processing unit performs the warp processing on an image of a second view object of the warp object image based on a second warp parameter for the distortion correction.

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Appl. No.: 18/618059

Filed: March 27, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240265488 A1	Aug. 08, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2020-164508	Sep. 30, 2020
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Related U.S. Application Data

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G06T3/18** (20240101); **G02B27/01** (20060101); **G06T5/50** (20060101); **G06T5/80** (20240101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G06T3/18** (20240101); **G02B27/0101** (20130101); **G06T5/50** (20130101); **G06T5/80** (20240101); **G02B2027/014** (20130101); **G06T2207/20221** (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

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Background/Summary

(1) The present application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/486,996 filed Sep. 28, 2021, which is based on, and claims priority from JP Application Serial Number 2020-164508, filed Sep. 30, 2020, the disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(1) The present disclosure relates to a circuit apparatus, a display system, an image processing method, etc.

2. Related Art

(2) A head-up display that displays an image on a transparent screen or the like with information superimposed on a field of view of a user is known. The head-up display and an AR technique are combined, and thereby, a virtual object may be displayed to track a real object such as a car ahead or a road on the head-up display. AR is an abbreviation for Augmented Reality.

(3) While vibration correction is performed for the AR virtual object to track the real object, fixed views of meters etc., which are not required to track the real object, may be desired. Further, in the head-up display, the image is distorted due to a curved surface of the transparent screen or the like, and distortion correction for correcting the distortion is performed. JP-A-2020-050328 discloses a technique of synthesizing an image requiring vibration correction and an image not requiring vibration correction on a frame memory and correcting distortion of the synthesized image. Further, JP-A-2009-179214 discloses a technique of separately performing position correction and distortion correction and changing a parameter for the distortion correction with respect to each image area in the distortion correction. Furthermore, JP-A-2017-94882 discloses a technique of synthesizing a plurality of pictures including a first picture with position correction and a second picture without position correction, however, the first picture and the second picture are separate pictures.

(4) In view of accurate correction of a position difference of the AR virtual object relative to the real object, it is desirable that the time of vibration correction is close to the time of display on the head-up display. However, in JP-A-2020-050328 and JP-A-2009-179214, distortion correction is performed after vibration correction or position correction, and the processing time from the vibration correction or position correction to output to the head-up display is longer. In JP-A-2017-94882, a plurality of different pictures are corrected and synthesized, and the processing time from position correction to output to the head-up display is longer. As described above, in related art, in the HUD in which an AR view and a fixed view are mixed, there is a problem that the processing time from the vibration correction or position correction to output to the head-up display is longer and correction of the position difference is insufficient.

SUMMARY

(5) An aspect of the present disclosure relates to a circuit apparatus used for a head-up display that displays a first view object corresponding to a real object in a real space and a second view object in a display area, including a memory unit that stores a warp object image containing an image of the first view object and an image of the second view object, and a warp processing unit that performs warp processing on the warp object image and generates a display image displayed in the display area, wherein the warp processing unit performs the warp processing on the image of the first view object of the warp object image based on a first warp parameter for vibration correction of a display position difference of the first view object relative to the real object and distortion

correction according to at least one of curvature of the display area and distortion in an optical system, and performs the warp processing on the image of the second view object of the warp object image based on a second warp parameter for the distortion correction.

(6) Another aspect of the present disclosure relates to a display system of a head-up display that displays a first view object corresponding to a real object in a real space and a second view object in a display area, including a memory unit that stores a warp object image containing an image of the first view object and an image of the second view object, and a warp processing unit that performs warp processing on the warp object image and generates a display image displayed in the display area, wherein the warp processing unit performs the warp processing on the image of the first view object of the warp object image based on a first warp parameter for vibration correction of a display position difference of the first view object relative to the real object and distortion correction according to at least one of curvature of the display area and distortion in an optical system, and performs the warp processing on the image of the second view object of the warp object image based on a second warp parameter for the distortion correction.

(7) Yet another aspect of the present disclosure relates to an image processing method for a head-up display that displays a first view object corresponding to a real object in a real space and a second view object in a display area, including performing warp processing on a warp object image containing an image of the first view object and an image of the second view object and generating a display image displayed in the display area, performing the warp processing on the image of the first view object of the warp object image based on a first warp parameter for vibration correction of a display position difference of the first view object relative to the real object and distortion correction according to at least one of curvature of the display area and distortion in an optical system, and performing the warp processing on the image of the second view object of the warp object image based on a second warp parameter for the distortion correction.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 shows a first configuration example of a circuit apparatus.

(2) FIG. 2 is an explanatory diagram of processing performed by the first configuration example of the circuit apparatus.

(3) FIG. 3 shows a second configuration example of the circuit apparatus.

(4) FIG. 4 is an explanatory diagram of processing performed by the second configuration example of the circuit apparatus.

(5) FIG. 5 is an explanatory diagram of display position differences due to pitch displacement or perpendicular displacement.

(6) FIG. 6 is a diagram for explanation of latency compensation.

(7) FIG. 7 shows a configuration example of a display system in related art.

(8) FIG. 8 shows a processing flow of the display system in related art.

(9) FIG. 9 shows a configuration example of a display system in an embodiment.

(10) FIG. 10 shows a detailed processing flow of a tracking processing unit.

(11) FIG. 11 shows a processing flow of the display system.

(12) FIG. 12 shows a detailed configuration example of the display system.

(13) FIG. 13 is an explanatory diagram of warp processing.

(14) FIG. 14 shows correlations between tracking information of a vehicle or the like and latency compensation based on the tracking information.

(15) FIG. 15 shows examples of latency compensation parameters.

(16) FIG. 16 is a diagram for explanation of a method of calculating latency compensation parameters from tracking information.

(17) As below, preferred embodiments of the present disclosure will be explained in detail. The following embodiments do not unduly limit the details described in the appended claims and not all configurations explained in the embodiments are essential component elements.

1. First Configuration Example

(18) FIG. 1 shows a first configuration example of a circuit apparatus **160** used for an HUD. HUD is an abbreviation for head-up display. The circuit apparatus **160** includes a memory unit **161**, a warp processing unit **130**, and a warp parameter selection unit **162**. The circuit apparatus **160** is also called an HUD controller and includes e.g. an integrated circuit apparatus with circuits integrated on a semiconductor substrate.

(19) The memory unit **161** temporarily stores a warp object image WTIM input to the circuit apparatus **160**. Specifically, the memory unit **161** is a line buffer that stores image data for a number of lines necessary for warp processing. The number of lines may be a sum of the number of movement lines in perpendicular directions in warp processing and some margin. The memory unit **161** is e.g. a semiconductor memory such as a RAM. RAM is an abbreviation for Random Access Memory.

(20) The warp processing unit **130** generates a display image DSIM by performing warp processing on the warp object image WTIM and outputs the display image DSIM to an HUD **400**. The warp processing is coordinate transform between the warp object image WTIM and the display image DSIM, and includes distortion correction and vibration correction in the embodiment. As will be described later, the warp processing unit **130** performs distortion correction and vibration correction on an image area corresponding to an AR view and performs only distortion correction on an image area corresponding to a fixed view. AR is an abbreviation for augmented reality. The distortion correction and the vibration correction collectively executed by are coordinate transform of the warp processing. That is, a warp parameter expressing coordinate transform includes a parameter for distortion correction and a parameter for vibration correction, and the distortion correction and the vibration correction are executed at the same time by coordinate transform using the warp parameter.

(21) The warp processing unit **130** may be a forward warp engine or an inverse warp engine. Forward warp is conversion of moving respective pixels of an input image to the warp engine to arbitrary positions in an output image. The forward warp engine is a warp engine having a function of forward warp. Inverse warp is conversion of obtaining respective pixels of an output image of the warp engine from pixels in arbitrary positions in an input image. The inverse warp engine is a warp engine having a function of inverse warp.

(22) The warp parameter selection unit **162** selects a first warp parameter PRM1 when the image area corresponding to the AR view is warp-processed and selects a second warp parameter PRM2 when the image area corresponding to the fixed view is warp-processed. The selected parameters are output as a warp parameter PRMQ to the warp processing unit **130**. The first warp parameter PRM1 is a warp parameter for both the distortion correction and the vibration correction. The second warp parameter PRM2 is a warp parameter for the distortion correction, but not for the vibration correction. The warp processing unit **130** performs the distortion correction and the vibration correction on the image area corresponding to the AR view and performs only the distortion correction on the image area corresponding to the fixed view by performing warp processing using the warp parameter PRMQ output by the warp parameter selection unit **162**. Note that the first warp parameter PRM1 and the second warp parameter PRM2 are externally input to the circuit apparatus **160**. Or, the circuit apparatus **160** may include a parameter calculation unit that generates the first warp parameter PRM1 and the second warp parameter PRM2.

(23) FIG. 2 is an explanatory diagram of processing performed by the first configuration example of the circuit apparatus **160**. In FIG. 2, an example in which the HUD is provided in an automobile **30** is mainly explained, however, the HUD of the embodiment may be provided in various vehicles

including aircrafts, vessels, or two wheels.

(24) As shown in the left part of FIG. 2, the warp object image contains an image IM20 of a first view object and an image IM25 of a second view object. The images IM20 and IM25 refer to a part of the warp object image, but not refer to another image than the warp object image.

(25) Here, the first view object is a view object in the AR view, i.e., a virtual object displayed to track a real object in a real space in the HUD. In the lower part of FIG. 2, a car ahead 10 is a real object and a first view object 20 is displayed to track the car ahead 10. The image IM20 of the first view object is an image for display of the first view object 20 in the HUD. In the left part of FIG. 2, a hatched figure part is the image IM20.

(26) The second view object is a view object not tracking a real object in the HUD, and located in a display position fixed in the display image DSIM output from the circuit apparatus 160 to the HUD 400. When a position relationship between a viewer viewing the HUD and the HUD does not change, the display position of the second view object is fixed in a field of view of the viewer. In the left part of FIG. 2, characters “100 km/h” in the fixed view is a second view object 25. The image IM25 of the second view object is an image for display of the second view object 25 in the HUD. In the left part of FIG. 2, a character part of “100 km/h” is the image IM25.

(27) The warp object image corresponds to an input image in the warp processing of coordinate transform between an input image and an output image. Specifically, the warp object image is an image input from the memory unit 161 to the warp processing unit 130 and containing the above described image IM20 of the first view object and image IM25 of the second view object. For example, rendering processing of the AR view is performed in a processing unit outside of the circuit apparatus 160 and a rendering image thereof is input to the circuit apparatus 160. In the rendering image, at least the image IM20 of the first view object is rendered. For example, in the rendering processing, the image IM25 of the second view object is also rendered and the rendering image is stored as the warp object image in the memory unit 161. Or, the circuit apparatus 160 may include an overlay processing unit (not shown) and the overlay processing unit may overlay the image IM25 of the second view object on the rendering image and store the image as the warp object image in the memory unit 161.

(28) Note that the warp object image is not limited to the rendering image. For example, a plurality of images in which the image IM20 of the first view object is placed in various display positions may be prepared in advance and the image selected from the plurality of images may be input as the warp object image to the circuit apparatus 160. In this case, the image corresponding to the position in which the first view object should be displayed in the AR view is selected from the plurality of images.

(29) As shown in the left part and middle part of FIG. 2, the warp processing unit 130 performs the distortion correction and the vibration correction on a first area AR1 of the warp object image, and performs the distortion correction, but does not perform the vibration correction on a second area AR2 of the warp object image. Thereby, a distortion that cancels out the distortion generated in the HUD 400 is provided to the display image. Further, the display image contains a distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected image IM20' of the first view object and a distortion-corrected image IM25' of the second view object.

(30) Specifically, the warp parameter selection unit 162 selects the first warp parameter PRM1 when the warp processing of the first area AR1 is performed, and the warp parameter selection unit 162 selects the second warp parameter PRM2 when the warp processing of the second area AR2 is performed. Thereby, correction with respect to each of the areas is realized. The warp parameter selection unit 162 may determine the first area AR1 or the second area AR2 from the coordinates of the pixels warp-processed by the warp processing unit 130. In the forward warp, whether the pixels of the warp object image at the input side belong to the first area AR1 or the second area AR2 is determined. In the inverse warp, whether the pixels of the display image at the output side correspond to the first area AR1 or the second area AR2 is determined. The warp object image and

the display image are correlated by the distortion correction and the area can be determined from the correlation.

(31) Here, the first area **AR1** is an area containing the image **IM20** of the first view object, but not containing the image **IM25** of the second view object in the warp object image. Specifically, the first area **AR1** is the other area than the second area **AR2** in the warp object image. Note that, when the warp object image contains an image of a third view object and the third view object is for an AR view, the first area **AR1** is set to contain the image **IM20** of the first view object and the image of the third view object.

(32) The second area **AR2** is an area containing the image **IM25** of the second view object in the warp object image. Specifically, the second area **AR2** is an area containing the whole image **IM25** of the second view object in the warp object image. Note that, when the warp object image contains an image of a third view object and the third view object is for a fixed view, the second area **AR2** is set to contain the image **IM25** of the second view object and the image of the third view object.

(33) Note that the first area **AR1** and the second area **AR2** may be defined in the display image. In this case, the first area **AR1** contains the distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected image **IM20'** of the first view object and the second area **AR2** contains the distortion-corrected image **IM25'** of the second view object. As described above, the warp object image and the display image are correlated by the distortion correction, and the second area **AR2** can be set to contain the image **IM25'** of the second view object and the other area than the second area **AR2** may be the first area **AR1**.

(34) The distortion correction is processing of coordinate transform of the warp object image according to the curvature of the display area or/and the distortion in an optical system. The coordinate transform is coordinate transform to cancel out the image distortion due to curvature of the screen. The display image is an image displayed on the display panel of the HUD **400** and the display image displayed on the display panel is projected on the screen by a projection unit, and thereby, displayed in the field of view of the viewer as a virtual image without distortion.

(35) The vibration correction is processing of correcting the display position difference of the first view object displayed to track the real object in the AR view. The display position difference is generated due to a change in position or attitude of the vehicle provided with the HUD, and the vibration correction is performed according to the change in position or attitude of the vehicle. In the lower part of FIG. 2, the automobile **30** is the vehicle and a position difference of the first view object **20** relative to the car ahead **10** is generated due to the change in position or attitude of the automobile **30**.

(36) The vibration correction includes shift correction. Further, the vibration correction may further include rotation correction, scale correction, or both. A shift refers to a position difference of the first view object **20** relative to the car ahead **10** in horizontal directions or perpendicular directions. The shift correction is correction of moving the first area **AR1** of the warp object image in the horizontal directions or perpendicular directions in order to cancel out the shift. A rotation refers to a rotation of the first view object **20** relative to the car ahead **10** clockwise or counterclockwise. The rotation correction is correction of rotating the first area **AR1** of the warp object image clockwise or counterclockwise in order to cancel out the rotation. A scale refers to enlargement or reduction of the size of the first view object **20** relative to the car ahead **10**. The scale correction is correction of enlarging or reducing the first area **AR1** of the warp object image in order to correct the scale.

(37) The vibration correction is e.g. latency compensation, which will be described later. The latency compensation is to compensate for the display position difference generated from the time when the rendering image is rendered to the time the warp processing is performed. Specifically, the difference between the display position of the first view object determined or predicted from the tracking information at the time of rendering and the display position of the first view object determined from the tracking information at the time of warp processing is compensated. The

tracking information is acquired from a sensor and the details thereof will be described later. Note that the vibration correction is not limited to the latency compensation, but may be processing of correcting the change in position or attitude of the vehicle that is not sufficiently tracked by rendering. That is, without using the difference, for example, a low-frequency component of the tracking information may be used in rendering and a high-frequency component of the tracking information may be used in the vibration correction of the warp processing.

(38) As shown in the middle part and the right part of FIG. 2, the warp processing unit **130** outputs the display image to the HUD **400**. The HUD **400** projects the display image on the screen and the viewer views the screen, and thereby, the display image as the virtual image superimposed on the real space is seen from the viewer. In the lower part of FIG. 2, an AR view that a driver as the viewer views via the HUD **400** is shown. The driver views the car ahead **10**, a road on which the car ahead **10** is traveling, and a surrounding landscape through the windshield. Further, the driver views the virtual image projected within a display area **40** of the windshield by the HUD **400**. The display area **40** shows a range in which the HUD **400** can project the virtual image.

(39) The virtual image contains the first view object **20** and the second view object **25**. Specifically, in the display image in the right part of FIG. 2, the other parts than the image IM20' of the first view object and the image IM25' of the second view object are in black transparently displayed in the HUD **400**. Of the display image projected by the HUD **400**, the first view object **20** is projected by the image IM20' of the first view object and the second view object **25** is projected by the image IM25' of the second view object. In the virtual image, the other parts than the view objects are transparent and only the view objects appear to overlap on the real space from the viewer. Here, the whole virtual image generated by the HUD **400** is referred to as "virtual image" and the parts not transparent and recognized by the viewer are referred to as "view objects". Note that the background of the view objects is not necessarily transparent and, when the background is not transparent, specific parts of the virtual image may be referred to as "view objects".

(40) Of the virtual image projected by the HUD **400**, the first view object **20** is vibration-corrected and accurately tracks the car ahead **10** compared to a case without vibration correction. Further, the second view object **25** is not vibration-corrected and fixedly displayed in the field of view of the viewer and easily viewable without being affected by the change in position or attitude of the automobile **30**.

(41) In the above described embodiment, the circuit apparatus **160** is used for the HUD **400** that displays the first view object **20** corresponding to the real object in the real space and the second view object **25** in the display area **40**. The circuit apparatus **160** includes the memory unit **161** and the warp processing unit **130**. The memory unit **161** stores the warp object image WTIM containing the image IM20 of the first view object and the image IM25 of the second view object. The warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the warp object image WTIM and generates the display image DSIM to be displayed in the display area **40**. The warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the image IM20 of the first view object of the warp object image WTIM based on the first warp parameter PRM1. The first warp parameter PRM1 is the warp parameter for the vibration correction of the display position difference of the first view object **20** relative to the real object and the distortion correction according to the curvature of the display area **40**. Further, the warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the image IM25 of the second view object of the warp object image WTIM based on the second warp parameter PRM2. The second warp parameter PRM2 is the warp parameter for the distortion correction.

(42) According to the configuration, the vibration correction is performed on the first view object **20** tracking the real object and the vibration correction is not performed on the second view object **25** not tracking the real object. Thereby, the AR view may be realized and the view objects not for the AR view may be fixedly displayed in the field of view of the viewer of the HUD. Further, according to the embodiment, the vibration correction is performed with the distortion correction in the warp processing, and the vibration correction is executed at the time of the warp processing

close to the HUD display time. Thereby, compared to related art with the longer processing time from vibration correction to display like the above described JP-A-2020-050328, JP-A-2009-179214, and JP-A-2017-94882, the display position difference of the first view object **20** relative to the real object may be accurately corrected.

(43) Furthermore, in the embodiment, the circuit apparatus **160** includes the warp parameter selection unit **162**. When the warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the first area AR1 in which the first view object **20** is displayed, the warp parameter selection unit **162** outputs the first warp parameter PRM1 to the warp processing unit **130**. Or, when the warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the second area AR2 in which the second view object **25** is displayed, the warp parameter selection unit **162** outputs the second warp parameter PRM2 to the warp processing unit **130**.

(44) According to the configuration, the warp processing using the first warp parameter PRM1 is performed on the first area AR1, and thereby, the distortion correction and the vibration correction are performed on the image IM20 of the first view object. Further, the warp processing using the second warp parameter PRM2 is performed on the second area AR2, and thereby, the distortion correction is performed on the image IM25 of the second view object and the vibration correction is not.

(45) In the embodiment, the memory unit **161** is a line buffer.

(46) The warp processing is performed, for example, with respect to each line or several lines. Accordingly, it is only necessary for the memory unit **161** to store image data for the number of lines necessary for the warp processing of one line or several lines of the warp object image. Accordingly, the memory unit **161** may be the line buffer, not a frame memory.

(47) Note that the operation of the above described circuit apparatus **160** may be executed as an image processing method for the HUD as below. In this case, the subject of the respective steps is not limited to the circuit apparatus **160**. For example, the display system of the HUD, which will be described later, may be the subject of the respective steps.

(48) The image processing method is an image processing method for the head-up display that displays the first view object **20** corresponding to the real object in the real space and the second view object **25** in the display area **40**. The image processing method is to perform the warp processing on the warp object image WTIM containing the image IM20 of the first view object and the image IM25 of the second view object and generates the display image DSIM displayed in the display area **40**. The image processing method is to perform the warp processing on the image IM20 of the first view object of the warp object image WTIM based on the first warp parameter PRM1 for the vibration correction of the display position difference of the first view object **20** relative to the real object and the distortion correction according to the curvature of the display area **40**. The image processing method is to perform the warp processing on the image IM25 of the second view object of the warp object image WTIM based on the second warp parameter PRM2 for the distortion correction.

2. Second Configuration Example

(49) FIG. 3 shows a second configuration example of the circuit apparatus **160**. The circuit apparatus **160** includes the memory unit **161**, the warp processing unit **130**, and a layer selection unit **163**. The warp processing unit **130** includes a first correction section **131**, a second correction section **132**, and a synthesizing section **133**. Note that the explanation of the same configurations and operations as those of the first configuration example will be appropriately omitted.

(50) FIG. 4 is an explanatory diagram of processing performed in the second configuration example of the circuit apparatus **160**. Note that the operation after the display image is output to the HUD is the same as that of the first configuration example.

(51) As shown in the left part and the middle part of FIG. 4, the first correction section **131** generates a first correction image CIM1 by performing warp processing using the first warp parameter PRM1 on the warp object image WTIM. The warp processing is performed on the whole

warp object image WTIM. That is, the first correction image CIM1 refers to an image formed by distortion correction and vibration correction of the whole warp object image WTIM. The first correction image CIM1 contains a distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected image IM20a of the first view object and a distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected image IM25a of the second view object.

(52) The second correction section 132 generates a second correction image CIM2 by performing warp processing using the second warp parameter PRM2 on the warp object image WTIM. The warp processing is performed on the whole warp object image WTIM. That is, the second correction image CIM2 refers to an image formed by distortion correction of the whole warp object image WTIM. The second correction image CIM2 contains a distortion-corrected image IM20b of the first view object and a distortion-corrected image IM25b of the second view object.

(53) The first correction section 131 and the second correction section 132 are respectively separate warp engines. That is, the warp processing by the first correction section 131 and the warp processing by the second correction section 132 are processed in parallel by the respective warp engines. The warp engine may be a forward warp engine or an inverse warp engine.

(54) As shown in the middle part and the right part of FIG. 4, the synthesizing section 133 generates a display image DSIM by synthesizing the first correction image CIM1 and the second correction image CIM2. Here, the first area AR1 and the second area AR2 are defined in the display image DSIM. The synthesizing section 133 selects the first correction image CIM1 in the first area AR1 and selects the second correction image CIM2 in the second area AR2. Thereby, as shown in the right part of FIG. 4, the display image DSIM containing the distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected image IM20a of the first view object and the distortion-corrected, but not vibration-corrected image IM25b of the second view object is output. Information designating the first area AR1 and the second area AR2 is input from the layer selection unit 163 to the synthesizing section 133 and the synthesizing section 133 performs the above described selection based on the information.

(55) Or, the synthesizing section 133 may perform synthesis by a blending. That is, the synthesizing section 133 blends the pixel values of the respective pixels within the first area AR1 using $\alpha 1$ as a blending rate of the first correction image CIM1 and $1-\alpha 1$ as a blending rate of the second correction image CIM2 in the first area AR1. Further, the synthesizing section 133 blends the pixel values of the respective pixels within the second area AR2 using $1-\alpha 2$ as a blending rate of the first correction image CIM1 and $\alpha 2$ as a blending rate of the second correction image CIM2 in the second area AR2. For example, when $\alpha 1=\alpha 2=1$, the synthesis is the same as that in the above described selection. The information designating the first area AR1 and the second area AR2 is input from the layer selection unit to the synthesizing section 133 and the synthesizing section 133 performs the a blending based on the information.

(56) Note that “synthesis” here is not a synthesis with a significant delay such that one whole frame is synthesized on a frame memory at a time. In the above description, the examples of the synthesis include selection and a blending. More specifically, the first correction section 131 and the second correction section 132 perform warp processing on one line at a time and output a result for one line at a time. In this regard, the synthesizing section 133 performs selection or a blending on one line at a time and outputs a display image for one line at a time. Note that the processing may be performed with respect to several lines, and the number of lines is smaller than the number of lines of one frame.

(57) In the above described embodiment, the warp processing unit 130 includes the first correction section 131, the second correction section 132, and the synthesizing section 133. The first correction section 131 performs warp processing on the warp object image WTIM based on the first warp parameter PRM1 and outputs the first correction image CIM1. The second correction section 132 performs warp processing on the warp object image WTIM based on the second warp parameter PRM2 and outputs the second correction image CIM2. The synthesizing section 133

synthesizes the first correction image CIM1 and the second correction image CIM2 and outputs the display image DSIM.

(58) According to the configuration, parallel processing of the distortion correction and the vibration correction by the first correction section **131** and the distortion correction by the second correction section **132** can be performed. Further, the synthesizing section **133** synthesizes the first correction image CIM1 obtained by the distortion correction and the vibration correction and the second correction image CIM2 obtained by the distortion correction, and thereby, the display image DSIM in which the vibration-corrected area and the non-vibration-corrected area are mixed may be generated.

(59) In the embodiment, the synthesizing section **133** outputs the first correction image CIM1 as the display image DSIM with respect to the first area AR1 in which the first view object **20** is displayed. Further, the synthesizing section **133** outputs the second correction image CIM2 as the display image DSIM with respect to the second area AR2 in which the second view object **25** is displayed.

(60) According to the configuration, the distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected first area AR1 and the distortion-corrected, but not vibration-corrected second area AR2 are synthesized and output as the display image DSIM. Thereby, the first view object **20** for the AR view is vibration-corrected and the second view object **25** for the fixed view is not vibration-corrected. Further, the synthesis is performed by selection of the areas and, compared to related art of synthesizing in units of frames on the frame memory or the like, the processing time from the vibration correction to the HUD display is shorter. Thereby, the display position difference may be made smaller.

(61) In the embodiment, the synthesizing section **133** performs α blending of the first correction image CIM1 and the second correction image CIM2 and outputs the display image DSIM.

(62) According to the configuration, the distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected first correction image CIM1 and the distortion-corrected, but not vibration-corrected second correction image CIM2 are α -blended. Thereby, the display image DSIM containing the distortion-corrected and vibration-corrected first view object **20** and the distortion-corrected, but not vibration-corrected second view object **25** is generated. Further, the synthesis is performed by a blending and, compared to related art of synthesizing in units of frames on the frame memory or the like, the processing time from the vibration correction to the HUD display is shorter. Thereby, the display position difference may be made smaller.

3. Display System

(63) As below, the display system including the circuit apparatus **160** will be explained. Here, a case where the vibration correction is latency compensation is explained as an example, however, as described above, the vibration correction is not limited to the latency compensation. Further, the first view object as the object of the vibration correction is mainly explained, however, as described above, the second view object for the fixed view is also displayed on the HUD. Hereinafter, the first view object is referred to as “virtual object”. As described above, the virtual object refers to the object displayed to track the real object in the real space in the HUD.

(64) As shown in the lower part of FIG. 2, the display system of the HUD provided in the automobile **30** tracks the car ahead **10** or the like using a sensor such as a Lidar, renders the virtual object **20** based on the tracking result, and warp-processes and displays the rendering image on the HUD. In this regard, there is a delay due to tracking processing, rendering processing, warp processing, data communications, or the like between the time when the sensor samples and the time when the virtual object **20** is displayed on the HUD. The delay generated by the processing, communications, or the like is called latency.

(65) The latency causes a position difference of the virtual object **20** relative to the car ahead **10** or the like. That is, due to the difference between the position of the car ahead **10** or the like when the display system renders the virtual object **20** and the position of the car ahead **10** or the like when the virtual object **20** is actually displayed on the HUD, the virtual object **20** is displayed with a

difference relative to the car ahead **10** or the like. For example, in the rendering processing, if the position of the car ahead **10** or the like is predicted at a display time in the future, the predicted position of the car ahead **10** or the like and the position of the car ahead **10** or the like when the virtual object **20** is actually displayed on the HUD may be different because time elapses from the prediction time to the display.

(66) FIG. 5 is an explanatory diagram of display position differences due to pitch displacement or perpendicular displacement as examples. xyz show a coordinate system fixed to the automobile provided with the HUD. z directions are traveling directions of the automobile and x directions and y directions are orthogonal to the z directions and orthogonal to each other. When the y directions coincide with the vertical directions, the x directions are horizontal directions and the y directions are perpendicular directions or upward and downward directions. When the automobile is in an attitude such that the y directions do not coincide with the vertical directions, the x directions and the y directions do not coincide with the horizontal and perpendicular directions, however, for convenience, hereinafter, the x directions are also referred to as horizontal directions and the y directions are also referred to as perpendicular directions or upward and downward directions. The directions of arrows in the drawing are positive directions and, when it is necessary to clearly show positive and negative directions, +x direction, -x direction, etc. are used.

(67) The top part of FIG. 5 shows a state without a position difference between a virtual object **21** and a real object **11**. The real object **11** is an object existing in the real space and tracked in the AR view. For example, the car ahead **10** or the like in the lower part of FIG. 2 is the real object. A projection unit **36** of the HUD projects a virtual image on a windshield **35** and the virtual object **21** within the virtual image is seen from eyes **50** of a driver.

(68) The second part of FIG. 5 shows a position difference between the virtual object **21** and the real object **11** when the windshield **35** and the projection unit **36** shift in the +y direction by WSM. A perpendicular shift WSM is generated by a pitch rotation or a perpendicular shift of the automobile **30**. The pitch rotation refers to rotation around an axis parallel to the x directions and the perpendicular shift is translation in the y directions. When the display system of the HUD renders the virtual object **21**, the state of the top part is assumed, however, a time elapses to the display on the HUD and, when the perpendicular shift WSM occurs within the time, the perpendicular shift WSM is not reflected on the rendering image. Accordingly, the display position of the virtual object **21** is shifted in the +y direction by the perpendicular shift WSM of the windshield **35** or the like, and the virtual object **21** is seen as being displaced in the +y direction relative to the real object **11**. For example, when the automobile **30** repeats pitch motion due to irregularities of the road, the virtual object **21** is seen as being displaced to pitch upward and downward relative to the real object **11**.

(69) The third part of FIG. 5 shows a position difference between the virtual object **21** and the real object **11** when the eyes **50** of the driver shift in the +y direction by DEM. The windshield **35** does not move, but the eyes **50** shift in the +y direction relative to the windshield **35**, and the display position of the virtual object **21** shifts in the -y direction. Accordingly, the virtual object **21** is seen as being displaced in the -y direction relative to the real object **11**.

(70) The bottom part of FIG. 5 shows a position difference between the virtual object **21** and the real object **11** when the real object **11** shifts in the -y direction by RJM. The windshield **35** and the eyes **50** do not move and the display position of the virtual object **21** does not shift, however, the real object **11** shifts in the -y direction and the virtual object **21** is seen as being displaced in the +y direction relative to the real object **11**.

(71) FIG. 6 is a diagram for explanation of the latency compensation of the embodiment. In FIG. 6, the real object **11** and the virtual object **21** seen from the driver are shown. The left part of FIG. 6 shows a state in which the display positions of the real object **11** and the virtual object **21** coincide as seen from the driver. As shown in the middle part of FIG. 6, when the driver moves the head to the upper left, the real object **11** shifts to the upper left by MV. The display position of the virtual

object **21** does not change, and the real object **11** is displaced relative to the virtual object **21** by MV. As shown in the right part of FIG. **6**, in the embodiment, a shift amount MV by latency is compensated and the display positions of the real object **11** and the virtual object **21** coincide. The latency compensation is performed, and thereby, when the driver moves the head to the upper left, the state in the left part transitions to the state in the right part and the state with the position difference as in the middle part may be avoided. The details will be described later. In the embodiment, the latency compensation is performed in warp processing as close to the display time as possible, and thereby, the position difference due to latency may be made as small as possible.

(72) For consideration of latency in the display system of the HUD, a typical display system in related art and latency generated in the display system will be explained.

(73) FIG. **7** shows a configuration example of a display system **90** in related art. The display system **90** includes a sensor **65**, a processing apparatus **60**, an HUD controller **70**, and an HUD **80**.

(74) The sensor **65** is a sensor that detects a position, an attitude, or motion of an automobile, a driver, or a real object.

(75) The processing apparatus **60** includes a sensor interface **61**, a tracking processing unit **62**, and a rendering image generation unit **63**. The sensor interface **61** is an interface circuit that receives an output signal of the sensor **65**. The tracking processing unit **62** includes a CPU and tracks the position, the attitude, or the motion of the automobile, the driver, or the real object based on the output signal of the sensor **65**. The rendering image generation unit **63** includes a GPU and renders a virtual object to be displayed to track the real object based on tracking information of the automobile, the driver, or the real object.

(76) The HUD controller **70** includes a warp processing unit **71** that warp-processes the rendering image. The HUD **80** includes a display **81** that displays the image after warp processing. The display **81** is a display device such as a liquid crystal display device. The image displayed on the display **81** is projected on a windshield by an optical system, and thereby, the virtual object of the rendering image is displayed.

(77) FIG. **8** shows a processing flow of the display system **90**. Here, an example using an IMU and a camera as the sensor **65** is shown. The IMU performs sensing at a sampling rate sufficiently faster than the frame rate of the camera. t_{ck} , $t_{ck}+1$, $t_{ck}+2$ show exposure times of the camera. That is, an image obtained by the camera shows a position of the real object at the time T_{ck} or the like. Image signal processing is processing performed after the end of the camera exposure, which reads out a signal from an image sensor, and which includes a development process, etc.

(78) The tracking processing unit **62** tracks the position of the real object from the image after the image signal processing by visual inertial odometry. At this stage, the position of the real object at the exposure time t_{ck} of the camera is detected. The tracking processing unit **62** tracks the position of the real object by inertial odometry based on an output signal of the IMU at a time t_{od} after the visual inertial odometry ends and a result of the visual inertial odometry. Through the processing, latency from the exposure time t_{ck} of the camera to the time t_{od} of the inertial odometry is compensated and the position of the real object at the time t_{od} is detected.

(79) The rendering image generation unit **63** renders the virtual object in the position corresponding to the real object detected by the inertial odometry and outputs the rendering image to the warp processing unit **71**. In this regard, a data communication time from the GPU forming the rendering image generation unit **63** to the HUD controller **70** is generated. The warp processing unit **71** performs warp processing on the rendering image and the image after the warp processing is displayed on the HUD **80**. The first line to the last line are horizontal scanning lines of the display **81** and scanned one by one. Accordingly, a time to scan the first line to the last line is necessary for image display for one frame and, here, a time to display the first line is representatively referred to as "display time t_{dp} ".

(80) The virtual object displayed on the HUD **80** corresponds to the position of the real object at the time t_{od} . Accordingly, there is latency from the time t_{od} to the display time t_{dp} and a difference

may be generated between the real object and the virtual object depending on the motion of the automobile, the driver, or the real object in this period.

(81) As described above, there is a problem that a display position difference is generated due to the latency from the time when the tracking information is detected to the display time **tdp** by display of the virtual object rendered using the tracking information detected before the display time **tdp**. It is desirable to correct the display position difference at a time as close to HUD display as possible. As described above, in JP-A-2020-050328 to JP-A-2017-94882, there is a problem that the processing time from the correction of the position difference to the output on the head-up display is longer and the correction of the position difference is insufficient.

(82) FIG. **9** shows a configuration example of a display system **100** in the embodiment. The display system **100** displays a virtual object corresponding to a real object on the HUD **400** based on an output signal of a sensor **500**. The display system **100** includes a tracking processing unit **110**, a rendering image generation unit **120**, the warp processing unit **130**, a parameter calculation unit **140**, the memory unit **161**, and the warp parameter selection unit **162**.

(83) Note that the circuit apparatus **160** is not shown in FIG. **9**, however, the display system **100** includes a circuit block contained in the circuit apparatus **160**. A hardware configuration example of the display system **100** including the circuit apparatus **160** will be described later. Further, FIG. **9** shows an example in which the first configuration example of the circuit apparatus **160** in FIG. **1** is incorporated in the display system **100**. When the second configuration example of the circuit apparatus **160** in FIG. **3** is incorporated in the display system **100**, the layer selection unit **163** is provided in place of the warp parameter selection unit **162**.

(84) The sensor **500** is a sensor that detects a position, an attitude, or motion of a vehicle, a viewer, or a real object. The sensor **500** is provided in the vehicle and includes e.g. a Lidar, an IMU, a camera, an eye-tracking sensor, or a head-tracking sensor. The Lidar is an abbreviation for Light Detection and Ranging and a sensor that acquires three-dimensional information such as a z-map. The IMU is an abbreviation for Inertial Measurement Unit and a sensor that detects uniaxial or multiaxial motion. The IMU includes e.g. an acceleration sensor, a gyro sensor, or a combination of the sensors. The camera is a sensor that captures an image as two-dimensional information. The eye-tracking sensor is a sensor that detects a position of the eye of the viewer, a sight direction, or both. The head-tracking sensor is a sensor that detects a position of the head of the viewer, an attitude, or both.

(85) The vehicle is an object moving within the real space with the HUD **400**, the viewer, and the sensor **500** held therein, e.g. an automobile, two wheels, aircrafts, vessels, or the like. The viewer is a user viewing a virtual image projected on the HUD **400** and an operator or a passenger of the vehicle. The real object is an object existing within the real space. The real object may be an object varied in position or attitude in the HUD display area seen from the viewer when the position or the attitude of the vehicle, the viewer, or the real object varies.

(86) The tracking processing unit **110** tracks the position, the attitude, or the motion of the vehicle, the viewer, or the real object based on the output signal of the sensor **500** and outputs the result as tracking information. For example, the tracking processing unit **110** tracks the real object based on two-dimensional ranging information from the Lidar or two-dimensional images from the camera. Or, the tracking processing unit **110** tracks the automobile based on acceleration or angular velocity information from the IMU. Or, the tracking processing unit **110** tracks the eye of the driver based on the position of the eye or information of the sight direction from the eye-tracking sensor.

(87) The tracking information may be in any format as long as the information represents the position, the attitude, or the motion of the vehicle, the viewer, or the real object. For example, the tracking information includes coordinates indicating the position in the real space, an angle indicating the attitude, a vector indicating translation, or an angular velocity indicating rotation. Or, the tracking information may be information obtained by conversion of coordinates etc. in the real space into coordinates, an angle, a vector, an angular velocity, or the like on the image. The

tracking information includes first tracking information on the vehicle, second tracking information on the viewer, and third tracking information on the real object. Note that the tracking information may include at least one piece of the first to third tracking information and, e.g. the second tracking information on the viewer may be omitted.

(88) The rendering image generation unit **120** renders the virtual object based on the tracking information on the vehicle, the viewer, or the real object, and outputs a rendering image containing the virtual object. Specifically, the rendering image generation unit **120** obtains a position in which the real object is seen in the display area of the HUD **400** and renders the virtual object in a position corresponding to the position of the real object. Further, the rendering image generation unit **120** renders the second view object for the fixed view in addition to the virtual object as the first view object.

(89) The parameter calculation unit **140** obtains a latency compensation parameter based on the tracking information, corrects the warp parameter used for distortion correction based on the latency compensation parameter, and outputs the corrected warp parameter. The corrected warp parameter is a first warp parameter. The parameter calculation unit **140** outputs the warp parameter used for distortion correction as a second warp parameter. The tracking information used here is sampled after the tracking information used for the rendering processing. In order to minimize latency, it is desirable to use tracking information acquired just before parameter calculation or at a time as close to the calculation as possible.

(90) The latency compensation parameter is a parameter for compensation for a difference between the position of the virtual object in the rendering image and the position of the virtual object at the display time. The latency compensation parameter shows a shift amount or a rotation angle on the image data. More specifically, the latency compensation parameter shows a shift amount or a rotation angle in the image without distortion before warp processing.

(91) The first warp parameter and the second warp parameter are coordinate transform parameters in the warp processing and correlate coordinates of an input image with coordinates of an output image in the warp processing. The warp parameter is e.g. a matrix or a table showing coordinate transform between the input image and the output image.

(92) The warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing described in FIGS. **1** to **4** on the rendering image and generates the display image. The display image is an image displayed on the display panel of the HUD **400** and the display image displayed on the display panel is projected on the screen by the projection unit, and thereby, the real space and the virtual image superimposed thereon are seen from the viewer viewing the screen.

(93) The HUD **400** includes the projection unit for projecting the virtual image on the screen. The projection unit includes a display panel that displays the display image and an optical system that projects the display image displayed on the display panel as the virtual image on the screen. The screen is a window screen of the vehicle or the like. Or, the HUD **400** may include a dedicated screen and the virtual image may be projected on the screen. The optical system includes a mirror and a lens.

(94) FIG. **10** shows a detailed processing flow of the tracking processing unit **110**, and FIG. **11** shows a processing flow of the display system **100**. Note that the tracking processing shown in FIG. **10** is an example and a method of tracking the real object or the like is not limited to that. Further, the sensor used for the tracking processing may be chosen according to the employed method.

(95) The operation of the sensor shown in FIG. **11** is as described in FIG. **8**. The tracking processing unit **110** performs visual inertial odometry processing **111** based on an image IMG (tck) captured by the camera at the time tck and motion information MTI (tck) of the vehicle sampled by the IMU at the time tck, and estimates positions and attitudes Pr (tck) of the real object and the vehicle at the time tck.

(96) The tracking processing unit **110** performs inertial odometry processing **112** based on the

positions and attitudes $P_r(tck)$ and motion information $MTI(tnow1)$ of the vehicle sampled by the IMU at a time $tnow1$, and estimates positions and attitudes $P_c(tck, tnow1)$ of the real object and the vehicle at the time $tnow1$. $tnow1$ is after tck and before the start of the inertial odometry processing **112**. More desirably, $tnow1$ is after the end of the visual inertial odometry processing **111** and before the start of the inertial odometry processing **112**.

(97) The tracking processing unit **110** performs prediction processing **113** based on the positions and attitudes $P_c(tck, tnow1)$, and predicts positions and attitudes $P_p(tck, tnow1, tfuture)$ of the real object and the vehicle at a time $tfuture$ after $tnow1$. In FIG. **11**, an example of prediction of the positions and attitudes $P_p(tck, tnow1, tdp)$ for $future=tdp$ is shown. tdp is the display time of HUD. The prediction processing **113** predicts the positions and attitudes P_p in the future based on e.g. differential values of the positions and attitudes P_c obtained in chronological order.

(98) The rendering image generation unit **120** renders the virtual object based on the positions and attitudes $P_p(tck, tnow1, tdp)$ and outputs a rendering image. If this rendering image is displayed on the HUD **400** without change, the virtual object is displayed to correspond to the position of the real object shown by the positions and attitudes P_p .

(99) Here, the predicted positions and attitudes $P_p(tck, tnow1, tdp)$ are predicted using information at tck and $tnow1$, and not positions based on real sensor output at tdp . That is, when the real motion generated between $tnow1$ and tdp is different from the motion predicted by the prediction processing **113**, a position difference due to latency may be generated between the virtual object and the real object. That is, the latency to be compensated in the example of FIG. **11** is latency due to the processing time between $tnow1$ and tdp . Note that the latency to be compensated is not limited to that. For example, when the inertial odometry and the prediction processing are omitted and the rendering processing is performed using $P_r(tck)$, latency due to the processing time between tck and tdp is compensated.

(100) In the embodiment, the position difference due to the latency is compensated in the following manner. The tracking processing unit **110** performs the visual inertial odometry processing **111** based on an image $IMG(tck+1)$ captured by the camera at the time $tck+1$ and motion information $MTI(tck+1)$ of the vehicle sampled by the IMU at the time $tck+1$, and estimates positions and attitudes $P_r(tck+1)$ of the real object and the vehicle at the time $tck+1$. $tck+1$ is a camera exposure time next to tck .

(101) The tracking processing unit **110** performs the inertial odometry processing **112** based on the positions and attitudes $P_r(tck+1)$ and motion information $MTI(tnow2)$ of the vehicle sampled by the IMU at a time $tnow2$, and estimates positions and attitudes $P_c(tck+1, tnow2)$ of the real object and the vehicle at the time $tnow2$.

(102) The tracking processing unit **110** performs the prediction processing **113** based on the positions and attitudes $P_c(tck+1, tnow2)$, and predicts positions and attitudes $P_p(tck+1, tnow2, tdp)$ of the real object and the vehicle at tdp .

(103) The parameter calculation unit **140** obtains a latency compensation parameter based on the positions and attitudes $P_p(tck, tnow1, tdp)$ and the positions and attitudes $P_p(tck+1, tnow2, tdp)$. Specifically, the parameter calculation unit **140** obtains a latency compensation parameter to cancel out a position difference of the virtual object due to a difference between the positions and attitudes $P_p(tck, tnow1, tdp)$ and the positions and attitudes $P_p(tck+1, tnow2, tdp)$. The parameter calculation unit **140** corrects the warp parameter using the latency compensation parameter and outputs the corrected warp parameter.

(104) The warp processing unit **130** warp-processes the rendering image using the corrected warp parameter and generates a display image. Note that the corrected warp parameter corresponds to the first warp parameter described in FIGS. **1** to **4** and the warp processing using the corrected warp parameter corresponds to the warp processing including distortion correction and vibration correction. The warp processing is executed on the second area containing the virtual object of the rendering image as the warp object image. The warp processing unit **130** executes warp processing

of only distortion correction on the first area of the rendering image.

(105) The warp processing unit **130** sequentially performs warp processing from the first line to the last line according to the scanning times from the first line to the last line in the display panel of the HUD **400**, and sequentially outputs data of the respective lines after the warp processing to the HUD **400** according to the scanning times. In FIG. **8**, the display time of the first line is tdp , however, tdp may be any time in a frame period for display from the first line to the last line.

(106) In the above described embodiment, the display system **100** is the display system of the HUD **400** that displays the first view object **20** corresponding to the real object in the real space and the second view object **25** in the display area **40**. The display system **100** includes the memory unit **161** and the warp processing unit **130**. The memory unit **161** stores the warp object image WTIM containing the image IM**20** of the first view object and the image IM**25** of the second view object. The warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the warp object image WTIM and generates the display image DSIM displayed in the display area **40**. The warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the image IM**20** of the first view object of the warp object image WTIM based on the first warp parameter PRM**1**. The first warp parameter PRM**1** is the warp parameter for vibration correction of the display position difference of the first view object **20** relative to the real object and distortion correction according to the curvature of the display area **40** and/or distortion in an optical system. Further, the warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing on the image IM**25** of the second view object of the warp object image WTIM based on the second warp parameter PRM**2**. The second warp parameter PRM**2** is the warp parameter for distortion correction.

(107) Further, in the embodiment, the display system **100** includes the parameter calculation unit **140** that calculates the first warp parameter PRM**1** and the second warp parameter PRM**2**. The parameter calculation unit **140** calculates the first warp parameter PRM**1** based on the tracking information. The tracking information is at least one piece of the first tracking information on the vehicle provided with the HUD **400**, the second tracking information on the viewer of the HUD **400**, and the third tracking information on the real object.

(108) According to the configuration, the parameter calculation unit **140** can calculate the parameter for vibration correction based on the tracking information. Thereby, the parameter calculation unit **140** may calculate the first warp parameter PRM**1** based on the parameter for vibration correction and output the first warp parameter PRM**1** for vibration correction and distortion correction to the warp processing unit **130**.

(109) In the embodiment, the display system **100** includes the rendering image generation unit **120** that renders the warp object image WTIM. The parameter calculation unit **140** calculates the latency compensation parameter based on the tracking information and obtains the first warp parameter PRM**1** using the latency compensation parameter as the parameter for vibration correction. The latency compensation parameter is the parameter for compensation of latency including rendering processing latency of the warp object image WTIM.

(110) According to the configuration, latency compensation may be performed by the vibration correction. That is, the position difference of the virtual object generated due to latency caused by the rendering processing between $tnow1$ and tdp or the like may be compensated based on the latency compensation parameter. The latency compensation is performed in the warp processing performed immediately before display, and thereby, the residual latency may be minimized and the AR view with higher trackability of the virtual object to the real object may be realized.

(111) In the embodiment, the rendering image generation unit **120** generates the rendering image based on the tracking information at a first time. The parameter calculation unit **140** calculates the latency compensation parameter based on the tracking information at a second time after the first time and before the image display time tdp and the tracking information at the first time. In the example of FIG. **8**, $tnow1$ corresponds to the first time and $tnow2$ corresponds to the second time.

(112) According to the configuration, the latency between the first time and the display time is

shortened to the latency between the second time and the display time, and thereby, the position difference due to latency is reduced. In the explanation using the example of FIG. 8, the latency compensation parameter for correction of the warp parameter reflects the motion information sampled by the IMU at tnow2 after tnow1. The display position of the virtual object is corrected by the latency compensation parameter, and thereby, the latency between tnow1 and tdp is shortened to the latency between tnow2 and tdp. The warp processing is the processing performed immediately before the HUD display and tnow2 is close to tdp, and the latency may be made as small as possible and the display position difference of the virtual object due to latency may be made smaller.

(113) In the embodiment, the parameter calculation unit **140** corrects the warp parameter for coordinate transform according to the curvature of the display area based on the latency compensation parameter, and thereby, outputs the first warp parameter. The warp processing unit **130** performs the warp processing using the first warp parameter on the first area AR1 of the warp object image WTIM, and thereby, performs the latency compensation processing.

(114) As described above, the warp processing is performed using the first warp parameter based on the latency compensation parameter, and thereby, the latency compensation may be performed in the warp processing. For example, a configuration in which the image processing for latency compensation is separately performed from the warp processing may be considered, however, the processing load is heavier by the image processing of the latency compensation and the latency of the warp processing remains because of the warp processing performed after the latency compensation. In the embodiment, the latency compensation and the warp processing are integrated, and thereby, the latency may be minimized with suppressed increase of the processing load.

4. Detailed Configuration Example of Display System

(115) As below, the hardware configuration example of the display system **100** will be explained, however, the hardware configuration of the display system **100** is not limited to that. For example, in the following configuration, the parameter calculation unit **140** is provided in a processing apparatus **150**, however, the parameter calculation unit **140** may be provided in the circuit apparatus **160**. Further, in the following configuration, the circuit apparatus **160** includes the warp parameter selection unit **162**, however, when the second configuration example in FIG. 3 is employed, the circuit apparatus **160** may include the layer selection unit **163** in place of the warp parameter selection unit **162**.

(116) FIG. 12 shows a detailed configuration example of the display system **100**. The display system **100** includes the processing apparatus **150** and the circuit apparatus **160**. The processing apparatus **150** includes e.g. an SoC containing an interface **151**, the tracking processing unit **110**, the rendering image generation unit **120**, the parameter calculation unit **140**, and a memory unit **145**. SoC is an abbreviation for System on Chip. The circuit apparatus **160** includes the memory unit **161**, the warp processing unit **130**, and the warp parameter selection unit **162**. Note that the component elements already described have the same signs and the explanation of the component elements will be appropriately omitted.

(117) The interface **151** is an interface for inputting the output signal of the sensor **500** to the processing apparatus **150**. The interface **151** is e.g. a receiver circuit that receives the output signal of the sensor **500**. Or, the interface **151** may be a terminal to which the output signal of the sensor **500** is input. In this case, the output signal of the sensor **500** input to the terminal is input to a processor forming the tracking processing unit **110** and the processor receives and processes the output signal of the sensor **500**.

(118) The tracking processing unit **110** performs tracking processing based on the output signal of the sensor **500**. The rendering image generation unit **120** renders the virtual object based on the tracking information output by the tracking processing unit **110**. The tracking processing unit **110** and the rendering image generation unit **120** include a processor such as a CPU or a GPU. CPU is

an abbreviation for Central Processing Unit. GPU is an abbreviation for Graphical Processing Unit. The tracking processing unit **110** and the rendering image generation unit **120** may be realized by a single processor or respectively realized by individual processors.

(119) The memory unit **145** is a semiconductor memory such as a RAM or nonvolatile memory and stores a warp parameter before latency compensation. RAM is an abbreviation for Random Access Memory. As described above, the warp parameter is a matrix or a table. The warp parameter may be a forward map parameter or an inverse map parameter. The forward map parameter is a parameter that correlates the respective pixels of the input image with movement destination coordinates corresponding to the respective pixels or a parameter that correlates the respective pixels of the input image with relative movement amounts to the movement destination coordinates corresponding to the respective pixels. The inverse map parameter is a parameter that correlates the respective pixels of the output image with reference source coordinates corresponding to the respective pixels or a parameter that correlates the respective pixels of the output image with relative movement amounts from the reference source coordinates corresponding to the respective pixels.

(120) The parameter calculation unit **140** obtains a latency compensation parameter based on the tracking information, corrects the warp parameter read out from the memory unit **145** based on the latency compensation parameter, and outputs the corrected warp parameter as the first warp parameter. Further, the parameter calculation unit **140** outputs the warp parameter read out from the memory unit **145** as the second warp parameter. The parameter calculation unit **140** may be realized by the same processor as the processor of the tracking processing unit **110** and the rendering image generation unit **120** or may be realized by another processor.

(121) The warp processing unit **130** generates a display image by warp processing of the rendering image using the first warp parameter and the second warp parameter. Here, the rendering image corresponds to the warp object image. The warp processing unit **130** includes a logic circuit e.g. a gate array automatically placed and routed, a standard cell array automatically routed, or the like. The HUD **400** includes a display **410** and displays the display image on the display **410**. The display **410** is a display device such as a liquid crystal display device. The HUD **400** includes a projection optical unit (not shown). The projection optical unit projects the image displayed on the display **410** on the screen, and thereby, superimposes and displays the virtual object on the real space.

5. Warp Processing

(122) As below, the details of the warp processing will be explained with inverse warp as an example. Note that the warp processing may be forward warp or inverse warp, and the warp processing unit **130** may be a forward warp engine or an inverse warp engine.

(123) FIG. **13** is an explanatory diagram of the warp processing in the embodiment. The input image is a rendering image. The output image is a display image displayed on a liquid crystal panel or the like of the HUD. (xsrc, ysrc) show a position in the horizontal directions and a position in the perpendicular directions in the input image. (xdst, ydst) show a position in the horizontal directions and a position in the perpendicular directions in the output image.

(124) When correction of the warp parameter using the latency compensation parameter is expressed by $g(\)$ a position in a latency-compensated image is expressed by the following expression (1).

$$(125) \quad (xlat, ylat) = g(xsrc, ysrc) \quad (1)$$

(126) When distortion correction using the warp parameter according to the curvature of the screen is expressed by $f(\)$ a position in the output image is expressed by the following expression (2).

$$(127) \quad (xdst, ydst) = f(xlat, ylat) \quad (2)$$

(128) From the above expressions (1) and (2), coordinate transform between the input image and the output image is expressed by the following expression (3).

$$(129) \quad (x_{dst}, y_{dst}) = f \cdot \text{Math. } g(x_{src}, y_{src}) \quad (3)$$

(130) The inverse warp uses inverse transform of the expression (3) and is expressed by the following expression (4).

$$(131) \quad (x_{src}, y_{src}) = g^{-1} \cdot \text{Math. } f^{-1}(x_{dst}, y_{dst}) \quad (4)$$

(132) In the embodiment, the parameter calculation unit **140** obtains the latency compensation parameter $g_{sup.-1}$, calculates $g_{sup.-1} \cdot \text{Math. } f_{sup.-1}$ and corrects the warp parameter $f_{sup.-1}$, and outputs the corrected warp parameter $g_{sup.-1} \cdot \text{Math. } f_{sup.-1}$. The warp processing unit **130** generates the output image by the warp processing of the expression (4) using the corrected warp parameter $g_{sup.-1} \cdot \text{Math. } f_{sup.-1}$.

(133) Note that an object of the warp processing using the corrected warp parameter $g_{sup.-1} \cdot \text{Math. } f_{sup.-1}$ is the first area AR1 explained in FIGS. 1 to 4 and warp processing using the warp parameter $f_{sup.-1}$ is performed on the second area AR2. That is, the corrected warp parameter $g_{sup.-1} \cdot \text{Math. } f_{sup.-1}$ is the first warp parameter and the warp parameter $f_{sup.-1}$ is the second warp parameter.

(134) FIG. 14 shows correlations between tracking information of the vehicle or the like and latency compensation based on the tracking information. Here, six-axis motion information is obtained as the tracking information.

(135) Yaw displacement $\Delta\alpha$ is rotation displacement around an axis parallel to the y directions as the perpendicular directions as a rotation axis. The yaw displacement $\Delta\alpha$ produces a horizontal shift of the real object viewed by the viewer through the screen. The horizontal shift is a shift in the x directions as the horizontal directions. Accordingly, the method of latency compensation is horizontal shifting.

(136) Pitch displacement $\Delta\beta$ is rotation displacement around an axis parallel to the x directions as the horizontal directions as a rotation axis. The pitch displacement $\Delta\beta$ produces a perpendicular shift of the real object viewed by the viewer through the screen. The perpendicular shift is a shift in the y directions as the perpendicular directions. Accordingly, the method of latency compensation is perpendicular shifting.

(137) Roll displacement $\Delta\gamma$ is rotation displacement around an axis parallel to the z directions as anterior or posterior direction of the vehicle as a rotation axis. The roll displacement $\Delta\gamma$ produces a rotation of the real object viewed by the viewer through the screen. Accordingly, the method of latency compensation is rotating.

(138) A horizontal shift Δx is a shift in the x directions and produces a horizontal shift of the real object viewed by the viewer through the screen. Accordingly, the method of latency compensation is horizontal shifting.

(139) A perpendicular shift Δy is a shift in the y directions and produces a perpendicular shift of the real object viewed by the viewer through the screen. Accordingly, the method of latency compensation is perpendicular shifting.

(140) An anterior or posterior shift Δz is a shift in the z directions and produces reduction or enlargement of the real object viewed by the viewer through the screen. Accordingly, the method of latency compensation is reducing or zooming.

(141) FIG. 15 shows examples of the latency compensation parameters realizing the above described compensation methods. A matrix on the right side of the expression shown in FIG. 15 corresponds to $g_{sup.-1}$ explained in FIG. 13. m13 shows a horizontal shift and m23 shows a perpendicular shift. m12 shows horizontal skew. The horizontal skew is transform to distort a rectangle to a parallelogram, however, used as an approximation of rotation here. m11 shows a horizontal scale and m22 shows a perpendicular scale. m11 and m22 correspond to reduction or zoom.

(142) For example, when a case where only a perpendicular shift occurs is considered, m11=m22=1, m12=m13=0. Here, the expression in FIG. 15 is the following expression.

(143) $(xsrc, ysrc) = (xlat, ylat + m23)$ (5)

(144) In FIG. 13, the inverse transform $f.\text{sup.}-1()$ of the distortion correction moves $(xdst, ydst)$ to $(xlat, ylat)$. The expression (5) corresponds to shifting of the movement amount in the perpendicular direction by $m23$ and latency compensation is realized by the shifting.

(145) FIG. 16 is a diagram for explanation of a method of calculating the latency compensation parameter from the tracking information.

(146) Displacement generated in the vehicle, the viewer, or the real object may be converted into a shift amount or a rotation angle on the screen from a geometrical position relationship among the rotation centers of yaw, roll, pitch, the head of the viewer, the HUD screen, and the real object. Then, the matrix on the right side in FIG. 15 may be determined from the shift amount or the rotation angle.

(147) In FIG. 16, the method of calculating the latency compensation parameter from the tracking information will be explained using $m23$ showing the perpendicular shift in FIG. 15 as an example. Here, an example using pitch displacement $\Delta\beta$ and a perpendicular shift Δy_m of a vehicle 32 and a perpendicular shift Δy_p of a viewer 52 as the tracking information is explained.

(148) When a distance between a rotation center PTC of pitch and a screen 34 is DCF, the pitch displacement $\Delta\beta$ of the vehicle 32 perpendicularly shifts the screen 34 by $DCF \times \Delta\beta$. Further, the perpendicular shift Δy_m of the vehicle 32 perpendicularly shifts the screen 34 by Δy_m . As a total of the shifts, a perpendicular shift amount of the screen 34 is $DCF \times \Delta\beta + \Delta y_m$. If the head of the viewer 52 and a real object 12 do not move, for example, when the screen 34 moves upward by $+(DCF \times \Delta\beta + \Delta y_m)$, the position of the real object 12 on the screen 34 viewed from the viewer is seen as being lower by $-(DCF \times \Delta\beta + \Delta y_m)$ relatively with respect to the screen 34. Therefore, the latency compensation parameter in this case is $m23 = -(DCF \times \Delta\beta + \Delta y_m)$.

(149) Here, a distance between the head of the viewer 52 and the real object 12 is DPT and a distance between the screen 34 and the real object 12 is DFT. If the screen 34 and the real object 12 do not move, for example, when the viewer moves upward by $+\Delta y_p$, the position of the real object 12 on the screen 34 viewed from the viewer 52 is seen as being higher by $+(DFT/DPT) \times \Delta y_p$ relatively with respect to the screen 34. If the real object 12 is located sufficiently far, $DFT/DPT = 1$ may be approximated and the perpendicular shift amount of the real object 12 is Δy_p . Therefore, the latency compensation parameter in this case is $m23 = \Delta y_p$.

(150) In the above described embodiment, the display system 100 includes the memory unit 145, and the memory unit 145 stores the table correlating the coordinates in the display image with the movement amounts showing the movement destinations of the coordinates as the warp parameter. The parameter calculation unit 140 shifts the movement amount of the table based on the latency compensation parameter and outputs the table with the shifted movement amount as the first warp parameter PRM1.

(151) In the example of FIG. 13, $f.\text{sup.}-1()$ is stored as the table in the memory unit 145. In the example explained in FIG. 15 and the expression (5), the movement amount for moving $(xdst, ydst)$ to $(xlat, ylat)$ is shifted in the perpendicular direction by e.g. $m23$. That is, the table is corrected to the table for moving $(xdst, ydst)$ to $(xlat, ylat + m23)$.

(152) Or, the memory unit 145 may store a parameter of a conversion expression to convert the coordinates in the display image into the coordinates of the movement destination as the warp parameter. The parameter calculation unit 140 shifts the coordinates of the movement destination based on the latency compensation parameter and outputs the parameter of the conversion expression with the shifted coordinates of the movement destination as the first warp parameter PRM1.

(153) The conversion expression is e.g. a polynomial expression and coefficients of the polynomial expression are stored as the parameter of the conversion expression in the memory unit 145. In the example of FIG. 13, the parameter of the conversion expression showing $f.\text{sup.}-1()$ is stored in the

memory unit 145. In the example explained in FIG. 15 and the expression (5), the movement amount for moving (xdst, ydst) to (xlat, ylat) is shifted in the perpendicular direction by e.g. m23. That the conversion expression is corrected to the conversion expression for moving (xdst, ydst) to (xlat, ylat+m23).

(154) Note that the embodiment is explained in detail as described above, however, a person skilled in the art could easily understand many modifications without substantively departing from the new matter and the effects of the present disclosure. Therefore, the scope of the present disclosure includes these modified examples. For example, in the specification or the drawings, terms described with different terms in a broader sense or synonymous at least once may be replaced by the different terms in any part of the specification or the drawings. Further, the scope of the present disclosure includes all combinations of the embodiment and modified examples. Furthermore, the configurations, the operations, etc. of the sensor, the head-up display, the processing apparatus, the circuit apparatus, the display system, the electronic apparatus, the vehicle, etc. are not limited to those explained in the embodiment, but various modifications can be made.

Claims

1. A circuit apparatus used for a head-up display of a vehicle, the head-up display displaying a first view object corresponding to a real object in a real space and a second view object in a display area, comprising: a memory configured to store a warp object image containing a first image of the first view object and a second image of the second view object; and a warp processing circuit configured to perform warp processing on the warp object image and generate a display image displayed in the display area, wherein the warp processing circuit is further configured to: receive tracking information, the tracking information including positions of the real object that is continuously tracked in the real space and is in front of the vehicle; perform the warp processing on the first and second images of the first and second view objects of the warp object image based on a first warp parameter, the first warp parameter being determined relying on the tracking information to generate a first correction image; perform the warp processing on the first and second images of the first and second view objects of the warp object image based on a second warp parameter to generate a second correction image, the second warp parameter being determined without relying on the tracking information; and perform synthesizing processing on the first and second correction images to generate the display image, the display image including the first view object included in the first correction image and the second view object included in the second correction image.

2. The circuit apparatus according to claim 1, wherein the first warp parameter is for both vibration correction and distortion correction, the vibration correction is configured to correct a display position difference of the first view object relative to the real object, the distortion correction is configured to correct distortion due to at least one of curvature of the display area and an optical system, and the second warp parameter is for the distortion correction.

3. An image processing method for a head-up display that displays a first view object corresponding to a real object in a real space and a second view object in a display area, the image processing method comprising: performing warp processing on an image of the first view object of a warp object image based on a first warp parameter for both vibration correction and distortion correction, wherein the vibration correction is configured to correct a display position difference of the first view object relative to the real object, and the distortion correction is configured to correct distortion due to at least one of curvature of the display area and an optical system; and performing the warp processing on an image of the second view object of the warp object image based on a second warp parameter for the distortion correction, the second warp parameter is different from the first warp parameter.

4. A circuit apparatus used for a head-up display that displays a first view object corresponding to a

real object in a real space and a second view object in a display area, comprising: a memory configured to store a warp object image containing an image of the first view object and an image of the second view object; and a warp processing circuit configured to perform warp processing on the warp object image and generate a display image displayed in the display area, wherein the warp processing circuit is further configured to: receive tracking information, the tracking information including positions of the real object that is continuously tracked in the real space; perform the warp processing on the image of the first view object of the warp object image based on a first warp parameter, the first warp parameter being determined relying on the tracking information; and perform the warp processing on the image of the second view object of the warp object image based on a second warp parameter, the second warp parameter being determined without relying on the tracking information, and the first warp parameter is for both vibration correction and distortion correction, the vibration correction is configured to correct a display position difference of the first view object relative to the real object, the distortion correction is configured to correct distortion due to at least one of curvature of the display area and an optical system, and the second warp parameter is for the distortion correction.
